FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

PRE-DEPARTURE CHECKS

Procedure

MV INTEGRITY III | UVI: 414562

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

Document Number:	FUS-SMS-INT3-05A
Revision:	01
Date:	7 July 2026
Author:	Matthew Hilder
Reviewed By:	Belinda Brooks
Approved By:	Kirby Hamilton
Vessel:	MV Integrity III (UVI 414562)

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Revision History

Rev	Date	Author	Description	Approved
01	7 July 2026	M. Hilder	Initial issue	K. Hamilton

Approval

Role	Name	Date
Author	Matthew Hilder	7 July 2026
Reviewed	Belinda Brooks	7 July 2026
Approved	Kirby Hamilton	7 July 2026

Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the pre-departure checks to be completed before MV Integrity III departs on each voyage or operation.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5)(a). NSCV C7A, C7B, C7C, C7D. AMSA Guidance Notice P200607 (revised August 2023).

1.2 Vessel Particulars

MV Integrity III is a 7.68 m aluminium diving support vessel with an open deck layout, classified Class 2C Restricted (UVI 414562), powered by twin Suzuki DF175 outboard engines.

1.3 QR Code Pre-Start and Physical Logbook

A QR code pre-start checklist (Microsoft Forms) is affixed to the vessel and shall be completed digitally prior to every departure. A physical logbook is also maintained onboard as a backup.

2. RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1 Master

- Shall ensure all pre-departure checks are completed before the vessel departs.
- Shall not depart if any critical item fails inspection until the deficiency is rectified.
- Shall record completion via the QR code pre-start form and/or the physical logbook.

2.2 Crew

- Shall assist the master in completing checks as directed.
- Shall report any defects or deficiencies to the master immediately.

3. PRE-LAUNCH CHECKS

3.1 Hull and Structure

- Inspect the aluminium hull for damage, dents, cracks, or impact marks.
- Inspect outboard engines for damage including leg, propeller, and cowling.
- Confirm the vessel is clean and tidy with no loose items.
- Confirm all bungs are in place and secure.

3.2 Electrical and Batteries

MV Integrity III has two batteries with individual isolators and a battery selector switch (OFF, 1, 2, 1+2).

- Confirm both battery isolators are ON and the selector is set to 1+2 (BOTH).
- Confirm emergency power source is functional (3-hour capability per NSCV C5B).

3.3 Outboard Engines

- Confirm outboard trim is functional and chocks removed.
- Trim outboards up for launch (if trailer launching).
- Confirm outboard mounts are in good condition and fixings secure.
- Confirm securing strap removed for launch.

3.4 Steering

- Confirm steering is functioning and smooth. Refill steering fluid if necessary.

3.5 Fuel

- Confirm adequate fuel for the planned voyage plus 30% reserve.
- Fuel type: premium unleaded petrol with no ethanol.

3.6 Communications and Electronics

- Confirm VHF radio functional and on Ch 16 for distress monitoring.
- Confirm signalling light present and functional (NSCV C7B).
- Port Jackson (Sydney Harbour): monitor VHF Ch 13 for Sydney VTS.
- Botany Bay: monitor 12 for Botany Bay VTS.
- Before departure, check the published daily vessel movements schedule for the operating port(s) (Port Authority of NSW) and plan around scheduled large-vessel arrivals, departures, and berth shifts. Scheduled times change at short notice — monitor Sydney VTS on VHF Ch 13 and Botany Bay VTS on 12 for movement updates while underway.
- Defence precincts: contact the appropriate tower (Garden Island Tower or Waterhen Tower) on VHF Ch 14.
- Confirm chart plotter / ECS operational with current charts and backup (NSCV C7C).
- Confirm GNSS operational.
- Confirm echo sounder operational and transducer in good condition.

3.7 Navigation Lights and Signals

- Confirm navigation lights (port, starboard, masthead, stern) functional.
- Confirm all-round white light (anchor light) functional.
- Confirm auxiliary / deck lighting functional.

Note: a separate radar reflector is not required. MV Integrity III has an aluminium hull providing inherent radar reflectivity.

3.8 Ground Tackle

- Confirm anchor, cables, hawsers, and warps present and serviceable.
- Confirm sea anchor present (NSCV C7D, required for vessels <10 m).

3.9 Trailer Checks (If Applicable)

- Confirm trailer recovery winch functional and handle present.
- Confirm trailer load binder / secondary chain in place and functional.

4. SAFETY EQUIPMENT AND DOCUMENTATION

4.1 Lifejackets (NSCV C7A)

- SOLAS lifejackets located in the bow compartment for 100% complement.
- Crew also use auto-inflate 150 PFDs during operations.
- All lifejackets shall comply with AS 4758 and be fitted with self-activating light.

4.2 Lifebuoy (NSCV C7A)

- 1 x lifebuoy with self-activating light, present and accessible.
- Buoyant heaving line attached.

4.3 Torch

- Battery-operated torch for each crew member.

4.4 EPIRB (NSCV C7A / C7B)

- Float-free EPIRB (water-activated in float-free bracket) for vessels ≥7.5 m to <12 m without level flotation.
- 406 MHz, GNSS-equipped, registered with AMSA.
- Confirm EPIRB is in date (battery and registration).

4.5 Medical Supplies (NSCV C7A)

- First aid kit stored in the bow compartment — present, complete, and in date. Kit contents determined by risk assessment the vessel's first aid supplies risk assessment under GES 2015/01, based on Scale F with risk-based exclusions of prescription-only medications.
- Oxygen administration kit present for diving operations.

4.6 Firefighting Equipment (NSCV C4)

- 2 x 4.5 kg ABE-rated dry chemical powder fire extinguishers: one on starboard side under the gunwale near the helm, one in the bow compartment. Confirm present and in date.
- Fire blanket.

4.7 Distress Signals — Pyrotechnics (NSCV C7A)

- 3 x parachute distress rockets — present and in date.
- 2 x red hand-held flares — present and in date.
- 1 x hand-held orange smoke signal — present and in date.

4.8 Spill Kit

- Spill kit present and serviceable (absorbent pads, boom/socks, disposal bags, nitrile gloves).

4.9 Navigation Equipment (NSCV C7C)

Item	Requirement

Clock	May be included in other nav equipment
Pair of binoculars	Required
Echo sounder	Required
Nautical publications	Current edition
ECDIS / ECS / nautical charts	With backup for electronics
GNSS (e.g. GPS)	Where plotting equipment fitted
Speed and distance indicator	Required
Compass	Card 75 mm minimum diameter (<10 m)
Sound signal	Required for vessels <12 m LOA
Signalling light	Required

4.10 Bilge Pumps (NSCV Part G Ch 3 Table 1)

- 2 x manual bilge pumps (4.0 kL/hr each). Confirm operational.
- Bailing buckets onboard.

4.11 Documentation

- Safety Management System (this SMS).
- Emergency response manual (FUS-SMS-INT3-06 and addendums).
- Operations manual.
- MSDS register.
- Digital charts of the operational area.
- Marine VHF Radio Operators Handbook (NSCV C7B).
- Vessel SWMS (current scope of work).
- Vessel Certificate of Operation (COO).
- Logbook (MO504).
- AMSA Class 2C equipment guidance document.

5. PRE-DEPARTURE DECISION

If any critical item fails (propulsion, steering, safety equipment, structural integrity, NSCV mandatory equipment), the vessel shall not depart until rectified. Non-critical items are recorded and reported to the East Coast Operations Superintendent.

The master has the authority and obligation to refuse to depart if the vessel is not in a safe condition.

6. REFERENCES

- FUS-SMS-INT3-05B Vessel Start-Up and Shut-Down
- FUS-SMS-INT3-02 Risk Assessment
- AMSA Guidance Notice P200607 — NSCV C7 Class 2C Equipment Guide
- NSCV C7A, C7B, C7C, C7D, C4, C5B, C1
- Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5)(a)